

So then, there remains a Sabbath rest for the people of God,
 ἄρα ἀπολείπεται σαββατισμὸς τῷ λαῷ τοῦ θεοῦ.
 for whoever has entered God's rest has also rested from his works as God did from his.
 ὁ γὰρ εἰσελθὼν εἰς τὴν κατάπαυσιν αὐτοῦ καὶ αὐτὸς* κατέπαυσεν ἀπὸ τῶν ἔργων αὐτοῦ ὥσπερ ἀπὸ τῶν ιδίων ὁ θεός.
 Let us therefore strive to enter that rest,
 Σπουδάσωμεν οὖν εἰσελθεῖν εἰς ἐκείνην τὴν κατάπαυσιν,
 so that no one may fall by the same sort of disobedience.
 ἵνα μὴ ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ τις ὑποδείγματι πέσῃ τῆς ἁπειθείας.
 For the word of God is living and active, sharper than any two-edged sword,
 Ζῶν γὰρ ὁ λόγος τοῦ θεοῦ καὶ ἑνεργῆς καὶ τομώτερος ὑπὲρ πᾶσαν μάχαιραν δίστομον
 piercing to the division of soul and of spirit, of joints and of marrow,
 καὶ δικνούμενος ἄχρι μερισμοῦ ψυχῆς καὶ πνεύματος,* ἁρμῶν τε καὶ μυελῶν,*
 and discerning the thoughts and intentions of the heart.
 καὶ (estin) κριτικὸς ἐνθυμήσεων καὶ ἐννοιῶν καρδίας

Step 1 – Break the Text Down into its large-scale COMPONENT paragraphs by reading through it and following the logic. Color code:

So then, there remains a Sabbath rest for the people of God, ἀρα ἀπολείπεται σαββατισμὸς τῷ λαῷ τοῦ θεοῦ. for whoever has entered God's rest has also rested from his works as God did from his. ὁ γὰρ εἰσελθὼν εἰς τὴν κατάνανσιν αὐτοῦ καὶ αὐτὸς* κατέπαυσεν ἀπὸ τῶν ἔργων αὐτοῦ ὥσπερ ἀπὸ τῶν ἰδίων ὁ θεός.
Let us therefore strive to enter that rest, Σπουδάσωμεν οὖν εἰσελθεῖν εἰς ἐκείνην τὴν κατάνανσιν, so that no one may fall by the same sort of disobedience. ἵνα μὴ ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ τις ὑποδείγματι πέσῃ τῆς ἁπειθείας.
For the word of God is living and active, sharper than any two-edged sword, Ζῶν γὰρ ὁ λόγος τοῦ θεοῦ καὶ ἑνεργὴς καὶ τομώτερος ὑπὲρ πᾶσαν μάχαιραν δίστομον piercing to the division of soul and of spirit, of joints and of marrow, καὶ διεικνύμενος ἄχρι μερισμοῦ ψυχῆς καὶ ἑνεύματος,* ἁρμῶν τε καὶ μυελῶν,* and discerning the thoughts and intentions of the heart. καὶ (estin) κριτικὸς ἐνθυμήσεων καὶ ἐννοιῶν καρδίας

- Notice how these sections cluster together logically. Often the “break” will be at a punctuation point.

Step 2 – Bracket the component sections INTERNALLY first: Bracket the most closely connected propositions first, don't just start anywhere.

*	So then, there remains a Sabbath rest for the people of God, ἀρα ἀπολείπεται σαββατισμὸς τῷ λαῷ τοῦ θεοῦ. for whoever has entered God's rest has also rested from his works as God did from his.
G	ὁ γὰρ εἰσελθὼν εἰς τὴν κατάνανσιν αὐτοῦ καὶ αὐτὸς* κατέπαυσεν ἀπὸ τῶν ἔργων αὐτοῦ ὥσπερ ἀπὸ τῶν ἰδίων ὁ θεός.
M	Let us therefore strive to enter that rest, Σπουδάσωμεν οὖν εἰσελθεῖν εἰς ἐκείνην τὴν κατάνανσιν, so that no one may fall by the same sort of disobedience.
Ed*	ἵνα μὴ ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ τις ὑποδείγματι πέσῃ τῆς ἁπειθείας.
Ft	For the word of God is living and active, sharper than any two-edged sword, Ζῶν γὰρ ὁ λόγος τοῦ θεοῦ καὶ ἑνεργὴς καὶ τομώτερος ὑπὲρ πᾶσαν μάχαιραν δίστομον piercing to the division of soul and of spirit, of joints and of marrow, καὶ διεικνύμενος ἄχρι μερισμοῦ ψυχῆς καὶ ἑνεύματος,* ἁρμῶν τε καὶ μυελῶν,* and discerning the thoughts and intentions of the heart. καὶ (estin) κριτικὸς ἐνθυμήσεων καὶ ἐννοιῶν καρδίας
S	
In*	

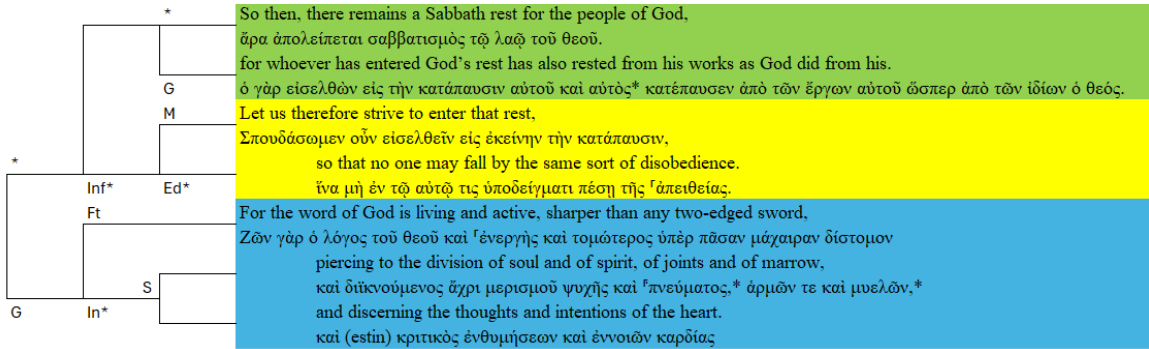
- In this example, you should bracket the last two “series” clauses first, before connecting them to the first clause in the blue block. This is what is meant by connecting the most closely connected propositions first.

Step 3 – Make a decision about which large-scale sections are more closely related and indicate the logic between them.

	*	So then, there remains a Sabbath rest for the people of God, ἀρα ἀπολείπεται σαββατισμὸς τῷ λαῷ τοῦ θεοῦ. for whoever has entered God's rest has also rested from his works as God did from his.
	G	ὁ γὰρ εἰσελθὼν εἰς τὴν κατάνανσιν αὐτοῦ καὶ αὐτὸς* κατέπαυσεν ἀπὸ τῶν ἔργων αὐτοῦ ὥσπερ ἀπὸ τῶν ἰδίων ὁ θεός.
	M	Let us therefore strive to enter that rest, Σπουδάσωμεν οὖν εἰσελθεῖν εἰς ἐκείνην τὴν κατάνανσιν, so that no one may fall by the same sort of disobedience.
Inf*	Ed*	ἵνα μὴ ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ τις ὑποδείγματι πέσῃ τῆς ἁπειθείας.
Ft		For the word of God is living and active, sharper than any two-edged sword, Ζῶν γὰρ ὁ λόγος τοῦ θεοῦ καὶ ἑνεργὴς καὶ τομώτερος ὑπὲρ πᾶσαν μάχαιραν δίστομον piercing to the division of soul and of spirit, of joints and of marrow, καὶ διεικνύμενος ἄχρι μερισμοῦ ψυχῆς καὶ ἑνεύματος;* ἁρμῶν τε καὶ μυελῶν,* and discerning the thoughts and intentions of the heart. καὶ (estin) κριτικὸς ἐνθυμήσεων καὶ ἐννοιῶν καρδίας
	S	
In*		

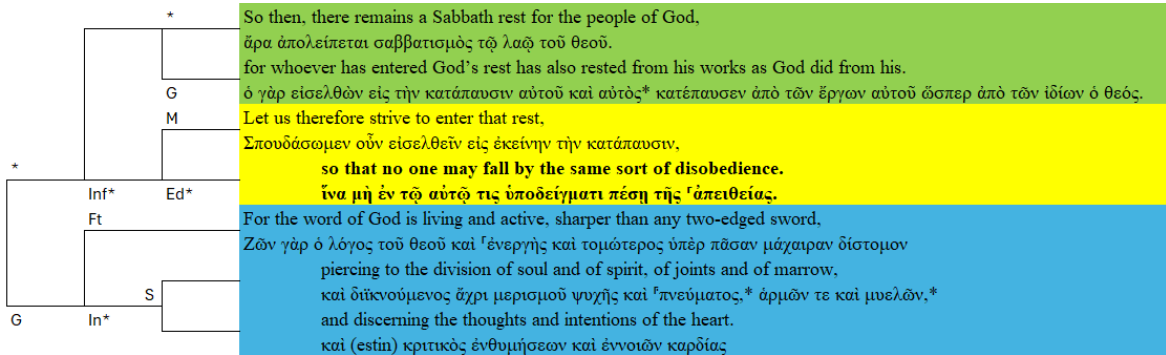
- This example could go either way, but for now I have decided that the green and yellow blocks are more closely connected and have indicated the “**inference**” relationship first.

Step 4 – Finish your DA until every section is connected:



- The final “**grounds**” relationship is now specified and all sections are connected.

Step 5 - follow the “stars” and highlight your main point. Check for logical validity.



- This is logically valid because both the green section and the blue section support the central exhortation.
 - o There remains a sabbath rest to be entered -> **therefore** strive to enter.
 - o The word of God uncovers the heart (no one will slip through) -> **therefore** strive.
 - o The central exhortation to strive has a **purpose** clause that is more semantically prominent, which is the avoidance of the fate of the first wilderness generation.
- Therefore: the semantic main point is the exhortation and the fate of apostates.
- Therefore: formulate your “exegetical” and “homiletical” main points accordingly, because a sermon on this text that chooses to (for example) camp out on the power of the word of God, but fails to see that that point is *in service* of the exhortation, has missed the main point.